

2024 STACK OVERFLOW SURVEY

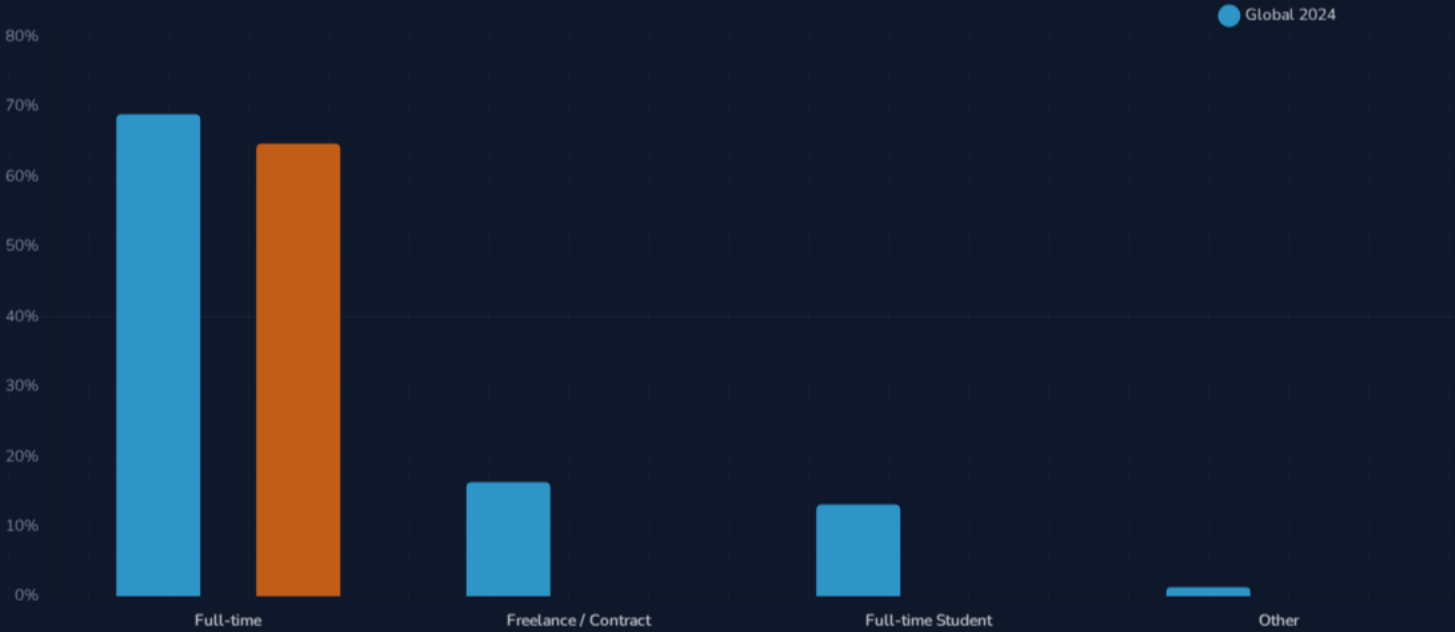
# Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

DATA-FORWARD ANALYSIS FOR ENGINEERING MANAGERS & HR LEADERS

EMPLOYMENT STATUS

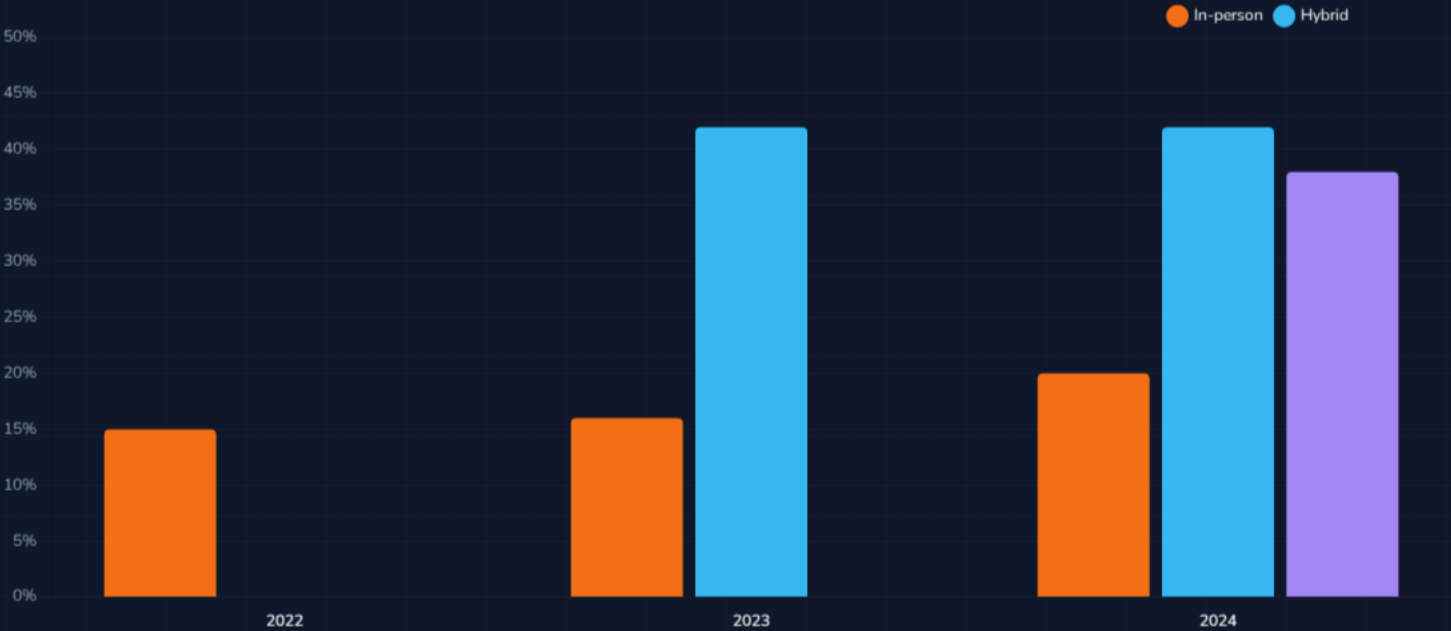
# 84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey (65,437 respondents). U.S. full-time dropped from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024).

WORK ENVIRONMENT

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey. In-person has risen for three consecutive years: 15% (2022) → 16% (2023) → 20% (2024).

COMPENSATION

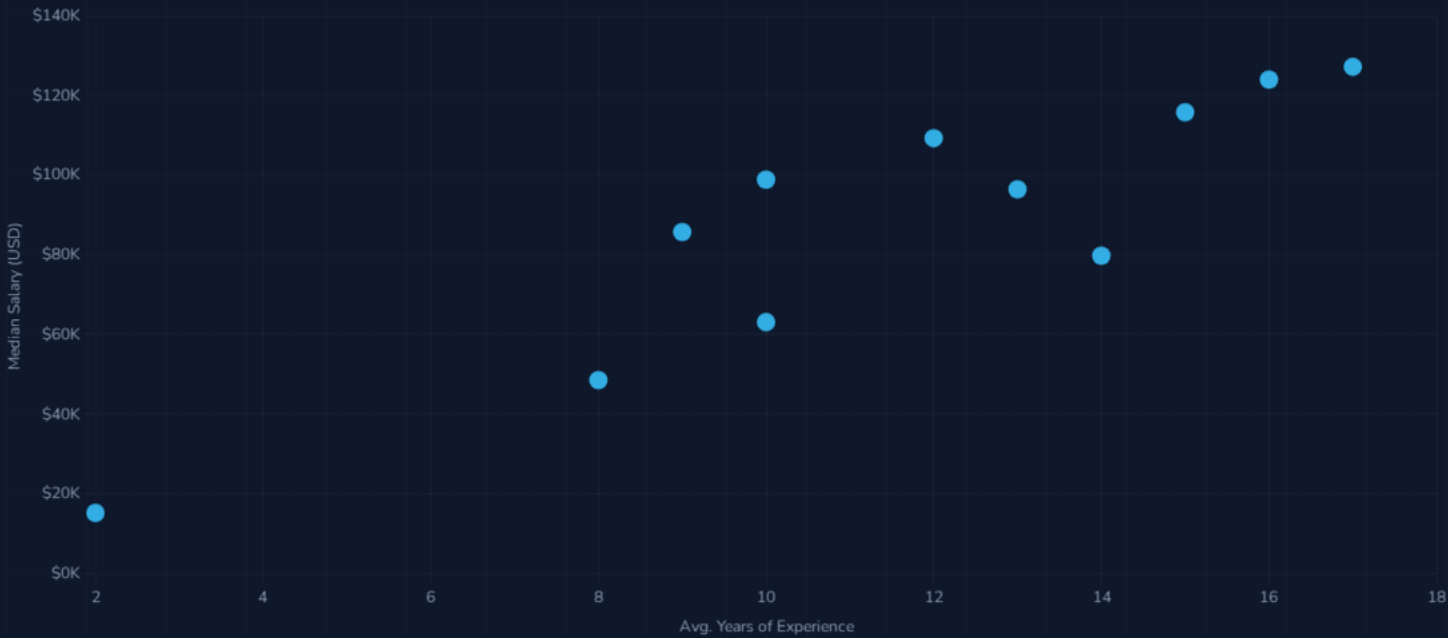
# Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey (22,677 salary responses, 34.7% response rate). Figure 1.

COMPENSATION

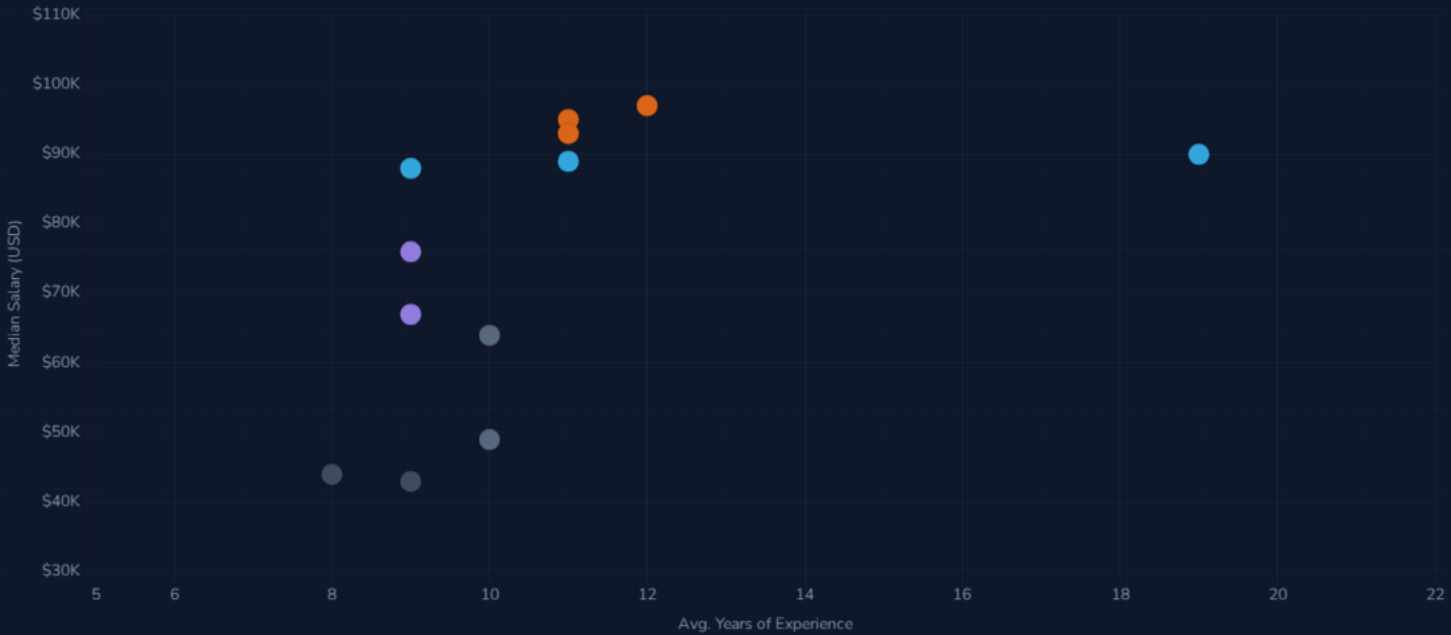
# Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey, Figure 2. SREs and Cloud Infra engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

COMPENSATION

# Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey. Figure 3. Overall reported salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–75K vs. \$70–85K).

# 47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

## Company Size Distribution

| SIZE                  | SHARE |
|-----------------------|-------|
| Freelancer / solo     | 6.1%  |
| 2–9 employees         | 10.4% |
| 10–19 employees       | 8.9%  |
| 20–99 employees       | 21.2% |
| 100–499 employees     | 18.5% |
| 500–999 employees     | 6.7%  |
| 1,000–4,999 employees | 11.0% |
| 5,000–9,999 employees | 3.8%  |
| 10,000+ employees     | 11.4% |

## Technology Purchasing Influence

62%

Have influence

60%

Prefer build-and-buy

75%

Start free trial

73%

Ask other devs

Senior executives (99%), engineering managers (87%), and product managers (77%) wield the most influence.



# What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

**Full-time employment is softening**

U.S. full-time fell 4 pp YoY to 64.8%. Plan for more contractors and flexible arrangements in your workforce model.

02

**In-person mandates are growing — but hybrid still dominates**

In-person rose from 15% to 20% over three years. Hybrid at 42% remains the preferred mode; forced RTO risks attrition.

03

**DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay**

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top charts. Expect competitive pressure for these profiles.

04

**Niche functional languages correlate with higher pay**

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. Language specialization can be a salary differentiator.

05

**Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly**

62% have a say in tech buying decisions. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management. Free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (73%) are the top evaluation methods.